

YUHAO JIANG

Post-doctoral Researcher, EPFL

CONTACT

EPFL STI IGM RRL, MED 1-1513
Station 9 CH-1015 Lausanne, Switzerland
Phone: +41 79 350 5266
Email: yuhao.jiang@epfl.ch
Website: yuhaoj.com, Google Scholar, LinkedIn

RESEARCH STATEMENT

I advance soft robotics through innovative mechanism design and AI-enhanced computational approaches, with a focus on robotic manipulation, multi-robot systems, and human-robot interaction. My research develops novel compliant structures and control strategies that enable sophisticated manipulation and coordination while minimizing actuation requirements. Through my work, I aim to enhance the capabilities of soft robotic systems in complex manipulation tasks and multi-robot scenarios, addressing key challenges in design, control, and human-robot interaction through the integration of soft structures and AI-driven approaches.

EDUCATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Arizona State University, Tempe, USA *Jan. 2019 - Aug. 2023*

Ph.D. in Mechanical Engineering

Advisor: Prof. Daniel Aukes

Dissertation: Design and Modeling of Soft Curved Reconfigurable Anisotropic Mechanisms

University of Florida, Gainesville, USA

Sep. 2015 - May 2017

Master of Science in Mechanical Engineering

Donghua University, Shanghai, China

Sep. 2011 - Jun. 2015

Bachelor of Engineering in Mechanical Engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EPFL, Lausanne, Switzerland

Sep. 2023 - Present

Post-doctoral Researcher, Reconfigurable Robotics Lab

Supervisor: Prof. Jamie Paik

SELECTED PROJECTS

MOZART: Morphing Computerized mats with Embodied Sensing and Artificial Intelligence

Sep. 2023 - Present

<https://mozart-robotics.eu/>

EPFL, Reconfigurable Robotics Lab

Funded by: European Union Horizon Europe Research and Innovation Programme

SCRAM: Soft Curved Reconfigurable Anisotropic Mechanisms

Jan 2020 - May 2023

<https://www.scrambots.com/>

Arizona State University, IdeaLab

Funded by: NSF EFRI C3 SoRo

TEACHING AND STUDENT MENTORING**Course Instructor**

Course Name	Affiliation	Period
ME410: Mechanical Engineering Product Design and Development	STI, EPFL	Fall, 2023-2025
ME420: Advanced Design for Sustainable Future	STI, EPFL	Fall, 2024-2025

Master's Thesis and Semester Project Advisor

Name	Topic	Program	Period
Goncalo Pais ¹	Development of Energy Storage and Release Mechanisms for Rapid Dynamic Motions in Canfield Origami Robots	MS in Mechanical Engineering	Spring 2025
Aurora Ruggeri ¹	Study on soft metamaterials for object sensing and geometry generation	MS in Mechanical Engineering	Spring 2024
Louis Flahault ¹	Kinematic study and design for spatial reconfigurable modular robotic platform	MS in Robotics	Spring 2024
Serge Asmar ¹	Locomotion design and control using surface wave change generated by ori-pixel platform	MS in Robotics	Spring 2024
Nicolas Nouel ^{2*}	Programmable surface using bistable structure	MS in Robotics	Spring 2024

¹ Master Semester Project ² Master Thesis * Co-advisor

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS**Journal Publications**

- [1] **Y. Jiang**, F. Chen, J. Paik, and D. M. Aukes, "Locomotion via Vibration of Soft, Twisted Beams with an Under-actuated Quadruped," IEEE Transactions on Mechtronics, June 2025, under review.
- [2] **Y. Jiang**, S. Asmar, Z. Wang, S. Demirtas, and J. Paik, "CPG-based Manipulation with Multi-Module Origami Robot Surface," IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters, March 2025, <https://doi.org/10.1109/LRA.2025.3555381>.
- [3] **Y. Jiang**, F. Chen and D. M. Aukes, "Tunable Dynamic Walking via Soft Twisted Beam Vibration," IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters, vol. 8, no. 4, pp. 1967-1974, April 2023, <https://doi.org/10.1109/LRA.2023.3244716>
- [4] M. Sharifzadeh, **Y. Jiang**, A. Lafmejani, K. Nichols, and D. M. Aukes, "Maneuverable gait selection for a novel fish-inspired robot using a CMA-ES-assisted workflow," in Bioinspiration & Biomimetics, vol. 16, no. 5, pp. 056017, August 2021, <https://doi.org/10.1088/1748-3190/ac165d>
- [5] M. Sharifzadeh, **Y. Jiang**, and D. M. Aukes, "Reconfigurable Curved Beams for Selectable Swimming Gaits in an Underwater Robot," in IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters, vol. 6, no. 2, pp. 3437-3444, April 2021, <https://doi.org/10.1109/LRA.2021.3063961>

Conference Publications

- [1] **Y. Jiang**, M. Sharifzadeh, and D. M. Aukes, "Reconfigurable Soft Flexure Hinges via Pinched Tubes," 2020 IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2020, pp. 8843-8850, <https://doi.org/10.1109/IROS45743.2020.9341109>
- [2] **Y. Jiang**, M. Sharifzadeh, and D. M. Aukes, "Shape Change Propagation Through Soft Curved Materials for Dynamically-Tuned Paddling Robots," 2021 IEEE 4th International Conference on Soft Robotics (RoboSoft), 2021, pp. 230-237, <https://doi.org/10.1109/RoboSoft51838.2021.9479208>

- [3] P. Bupe, **Y. Jiang**, J. Lin, T. Nguyen, M. Han, D. Aukes, C. Harnett, "Embedded Optical Waveguide Sensors for Dynamic Behavior Monitoring in Twisted-Beam Structures," 2024 IEEE 7th International Conference on Soft Robotics (RoboSoft), San Diego, CA, USA, 2024, pp. 139-144, <https://doi.org/10.1109/RoboSoft60065.2024.10521938>
- [4] M. Sharifzadeh, **Y. Jiang**, A. Lafmejani, D. M. Aukes, "Compensating for Material Deformation in Foldable Robots via Deep Learning – A Case Study," 2022 IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA), 2022, <https://doi.org/10.1109/ICRA46639.2022.9811752>
- [5] M. Sharifzadeh, **Y. Jiang**, R. Khodambashi, D. M. Aukes, "Increasing the Life Span of Foldable Manipulators With Fabric." Proceedings of the ASME 2020 International Design Engineering Technical Conferences and Computers and Information in Engineering Conference. Volume 10: 44th Mechanisms and Robotics Conference (MR). Virtual, Online. August 17–19, 2020. V010T10A087. ASME, <https://doi.org/10.1115/DETC2020-22757>

PATENTS

- [1] "Tunable Motion Using Flexible Twisted Beams", Daniel Aukes, **Yuhao Jiang**, Fuchen Chen - US Patent Application 20240391542
- [2] "Pinched tubes for reconfigurable robots", Daniel Aukes, Mohammad Sharifzadeh, **Yuhao Jiang**, Nicholas Gravish, Mingsong Jiang - US Patent US20230127106A1
- [3] "Buckling beams for underwater and terrestrial autonomous vehicles", D Aukes, M Sharifzadeh, **Y Jiang** - US Patent US20230121727A1
- [4] "Mechanisms for steering robotic fish", D Aukes, M Sharifzadeh, K Nichols, **Y Jiang** - US Patent US11124281B2

TALKS

Seminar Talks

- [1] "Empowering Actuation of Soft Robotic Systems via Soft Curved Reconfigurable Anisotropic Mechanism", hosted by Prof. Nick Gravish and Prof. Michael Tolley, UCSD, Feb. 2023.

Conference Proceedings Talks

- [1] **IROS 2025**: "CPG-based Manipulation with Multi-Module Origami Robot Surface"
- [2] **RoboSoft 2023**: "Tunable Dynamic Walking via Soft Twisted Beam Vibration"
- [3] **ICRA 2022**: "Compensating for Material Deformation in Foldable Robots Via Deep Learning – a Case Study", <https://youtu.be/AwS4vabv-JQ>
- [4] **ICRA 2021**: "Reconfigurable Curved Beams for Selectable Swimming Gaits in an Underwater Robot", <https://youtu.be/EszTDc9slyw>
- [5] **Robosoft 2021**: "Shape Change Propagation Through Soft Curved Materials for Dynamically-Tuned Paddling Robots"
- [6] **IROS 2020**: "Reconfigurable Soft Flexure Hinges via Pinched Tubes", <https://youtu.be/J5heXXD6mVo>

Workshop Presentations

- [1] **RoboSoft 2025**: "CPG-Based Motion Generator for Multi-Module Origami Robot"
- [2] **RoboSoft 2023**: "Model Order Reduction for Vibrational Soft Twisted Beams Using Pseudo-rigid-body Modeling – A Case Study"
- [3] **ICRA 2022**: "Modular Robots Using Soft Curved Reconfigurable Anisotropic Mechanisms"

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

The International Journal of Robotics Research (IJRR)
IEEE Transactions on Robotics (T-RO)
IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)
Soft Robotics (SoRo)
Journal of Field Robotics (JFR)
ASME Journal of Mechanisms and Robotics (JMR)

Conference Reviewer

IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)
International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)
International Conference on Soft Robotics (Robosoft)
ACM Symposium on Computational Fabrication (SCF)

Grant Reviewer

Swiss National AI Institute (Seed Grant Program)

PUBLIC OUTREACH

Media Interview

- [1] **RTS Education and Scientific Program:** feature in “A guide to the future: Seiss Federal Institute of Technology 02”, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9yoNLg5Qho0&t=560s>

Event Organization

- [1] **IROS 2025 Workshop :** “S'MORE: Shape-Morphing Robotics via Embodied Sensing and Mechanisms”, <https://www.shapemorphingrobot.com/>
- [2] **2024 RRL Demo Day:** Full-day public event for research projects from RRL and ME-410 and ME-420 class, <https://www.paikslab.com/courses>
- [3] **2023 RRL Demo Day:** Full-day public event for research projects from RRL and ME-410 class, <https://www.paikslab.com/courses>
- [4] **Robosoft 2021 Workshop :** “Breaking the Mold: Challenging Current Paradigms in Soft Robotics”, <https://www.scrambots.com/robosoft-2021-workshop>

Demos and Expositions

- [1] RRL lab tours (~6 times per year)
- [2] Swiss Robotics Day (2023 - 2025)
- [3] IdeaLab lab tours (~4 times per year)
- [4] 2019 Southwest Robotics Symposium (SWRS)